

turn up the volume all the way to the 80 per cent mark to check for distortion or when you put on a pair of headphones and jump up and down to check for the grip and fit.



Tablets are all the rage right now, and there's no stopping their invasion. With so many tablets launching from so many different brands, how do you go about buying the right tablet? Crucially, how do you differentiate between tablets that are really good and those that aren't so good?

Research

1. Before you venture out, read online performance benchmarks of your prospective tablet purchase. Observe battery life figures, as that's one thing you won't be able to test in a mall.
2. Visit technology forums and find if there are any manufacturing defects with the tablet you're purchasing. For instance, the Google Nexus 7 everyone raved about had in-built speaker issues and screen lift-off, a common nuisance reported by several early adopters of the eagerly anticipated Google tablet.

Observe

1. Responsiveness: One great way of testing any touchscreen's UI (and also the underlying processor speed) is by rapidly flipping back and forth through the tablet's home screens.



How comfortable are you with the tablet? Check viewing angles, speaker volume, etc.

- If there's any lag, you'll notice it here more than anywhere else.
2. Keypad test: If you're going to use a tablet for reading and responding to emails, make sure you thoroughly test out its keyboard. Typing with both hands while holding a 10-inch tablet, for example, can get a little dodgy at times. So yeah, convince yourself that you're comfortable with the keypad.
3. Screen under sunlight: This may not work indoors, but try convincing the mall attendant to accompany you outside so you could test the tablet's under ambient sunlight, and not just controlled artificial lights. In some malls you might be able to go near a window and test this out, in others, you may not be able to. Also, play a movie trailer on YouTube, specially one that has a lot of dark portions in it and then see how reflective the screen is. Make sure you check for reflections indoors without having

- any light source in the background.
4. Graphics: Test graphics by running GLBenchmark 2.1.5 through Google Play Store. Play a game such as Horn (<http://dgit.in/SNpl9a>). Of course, you'll need to have access to the Internet to do all this, so ask for it.
5. Is it the right screen size: If you're buying a tablet for reading ebooks, then ensure you hold it in one hand only and see if it fits well and doesn't feel too heavy. In our experience, 7-inch tablets are better for reading ebooks than 10-inch ones, purely because of the more manageable weight. An iPad is too heavy to hold in one hand for hours while you read a book.

Ask

Don't hesitate to ask if the tablet you're interested in purchasing comes with any freebies. A micro-SD card would be the most basic freebie that stores regularly offer, apart from screen covers and carry cases. **4**



- DIGI POWER DESIGN
- DUAL-STACK MOSFET
- PREMIUM ALLOY CHOKE
- MULTIPLE FILTER CAP
- TWIN-POWER COOLING HEATSINK
- 8 LAYER PCB, 4 X 2oz COPPER



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ASRock